

1 Research

Since 2017, when I have submitted my materials for promotion to associate professor with tenure, I have published 36 peer reviewed articles, including 7 in *Cities*, a journal with impact factor (IF)=7.8, higher than widely considered the top journal in public administration in the US, *Public Administration Review* with IF=6.2.¹ Four articles are in *Social Indicators Research* (out of which 1 provisionally accepted/minor revisions), and 9 in *Applied Research in Quality of Life*, both leading/main journals in my field.

2 Teaching

I am 2025 recipient of the department's Jay A Sigler award for "outstanding service and dedication to students" (awarded by students); the plaque says "this award is given to the faculty member who exhibits a commitment to student's academic development and personal growth."

Since 2020, I graduated 4 PhDs, they all have a job. One is at SIPRI (Stockholm International Peace Research Institute), a think-tank ranked 11th or 31st worldwide.² Another one at Virginia Tech and the other 2 were employed at Rutgers when they graduated.

My students publish. Since 2020, I have published 10 peer-reviewed papers with my students (9 published and 1 provisionally accepted/minor revisions) in good journals including 3 in top ranked *Cities* with Impact Factor of 7.8.

I make sure I am available and approachable for students spending extra time outside of the classroom: working on papers, being accessible via zoom and in person, including when on sabbatical. Now in Spring 2026 I am on sabbatical, but I still have 4 students enrolled in my dissertation hours, and I work with others on papers.

One highlight is unusually heavy curriculum development. Since coming to Rutgers-Camden in 2012, I have taught over 10 different classes, developed from scratch most of them, including 3 courses in 2023 for our new data science program. I am updating my teaching materials each time I teach a class.

I strive to improve my teaching: I just attended cybersecurity training (most of my teaching is computer coding or data science—cybersecurity matters there), and attended Instructional Design and Technology (IDT) workshop on "Crafting the Learner-Centered Syllabus" in 2024. And I quite regularly read on teaching and mentoring advice, tips and tricks on *nature.com*, *chronicle.com*, and *insidehighered.com*.

One highlight is that the skills learned in my classes work in the real world:

The classes I took with you are helping not only my scholarship, but my day job. Thank you [...]
I greatly appreciate it.

Subject: Received a Job Offer [...] I would like to thank you for all of the guidance and knowledge during all of your data-related courses the past several semesters to help me get to the point I am at today.

Since graduating I have continued to pursue more projects in the coding world. Some analysis projects, business models, and even some fun web apps and game designs. I appreciate all the help and motivation you gave me in class as it helped me to really see what I can come up with from

¹<https://www.scimagojr.com/journalsearch.php?q=16956&tip=sid> and <https://www.scimagojr.com/journalsearch.php?q=17167&tip=sid>

²<https://thinktankalert.com/rankings> and <https://guides.library.upenn.edu/c.php?g=1035991&p=7509972>

all of the useful tools, how to plan and build on projects, and skills gained from having you as my professor.

And students appreciate my approach and style:

I am reaching out to explore the possibility of having you as my graduate advisor. My experience in your Data Management course left a lasting impression on me and I appreciated your approach and teaching style. I believe your guidance would be invaluable in helping me navigate the academic journey towards finishing my doctoral degree.

This is Teacher Appreciation Week and I just wanted to take a moment to say thank you for all the hard work and dedication you put into teaching. Your passion for education has inspired and impacted me in so many ways. Your commitment to helping your students grow and learn is truly admirable. Thank you for all that you do!

Please know that I deeply appreciate everything you have done for me, and I recognize the many ways you have helped me grow as a scholar and, frankly, as an agentic person in general. I am truly grateful for you.

And my classes might have even contributed to retention in the program:

I have learnt so much about my region is really unbelievable and I have enjoyed working with you a lot. So much, I am actually considering STAYING in the program because of you!

3 Service

My service mostly builds on and derives from my main focus and strength, research. I provide such service in two main ways: 1) to the profession/scholarly field, and 2) to students.

I review about 3-4/mo or 36-48/year papers for journals, including the top journals such as Journal of Personality and Social Psychology and Public Administration Review (see CV for details).

Reviewing is an essential foundation of scholarly fields, and it is increasingly in short supply—something I can attest as a journal editor. Since January 2024, I co-edit Social Indicators Research, the leading journal in my field of quality of life and wellbeing. My editorial philosophy is to be mentor and helper, not just gate-keeper—for instance, I am often in favor of revision prior to external review, and I try to guide the authors, especially the junior ones.

My research-oriented service over past 6 years 2020-2026 to students is: published 10 peer-reviewed articles with students as co-authors (9 published and 1 provisionally accepted/minor revisions), supervised 8 dissertations (4 graduated; 4 in-progress), served on 6 dissertation committees, supervised 6 data science master theses, served on 2 master thesis committees in other social science, and supervised 15 independent studies. I have also led brown bag seminars and organized a workshop on academic publishing.

And I am very excited about bringing to campus an award winning junior professor from Germany as a visiting scholar for 2 months in Fall 2026: Leonie C. Steckermeier. Leonie is a productive scholar already benefiting 2 of our doctoral students—we have monthly or so zoom meetings where we are already working on papers.

I contribute service to the campus and department. Over 2018-2022 I have led the development of a new MS in data science and associated certificate program. This was a substantial undertaking and also somewhat challenging as the newly created programs are located outside of my home department. I have been serving since 2022 as a director for data science certificate.³

³See certificates at the bottom of the page: <https://graduateschool1.camden.rutgers.edu/graduate-programs>.

I am currently supervising 2 courtesy appointments as volunteer researchers in the department—they work with me on research but also helped students in my class. I frequently serve as either ad hoc chair or member on the Advancement and Promotions (A&P) committee. I find this service fulfilling. I contribute to promoting quality faculty in our social sciences and I learn about my colleagues. Other committee service is enumerated in the CV.

While research-oriented service is my strength and passion, and usual campus and departmental service is my duty, I am also mindful of Rutgers-Camden public/community service/engagement mission. I agree that as a public university, we also need to engage with and provide service to the public and community. I have assisted a number of Rutgers-Camden students in their community projects over past 5 years serving as a faculty advisor for, for instance: Olorunfunmi Adebajo's internship at the Camden County Community Development Office's Homelessness Assistance Unit,⁴ Marlo Rossi's project at Walter Rand Institute and other projects on abortion,⁵ and Ojobo Agbo Eje: "Camden Health Equity Data Visualization Initiative."⁶

New Jersey first, but I have been civically engaged outside of the Garden State as well. For instance, I have used my data management skills to assist with data collection and management for Ohio Business Round Table, and Michigan Economic Competitiveness Study.

⁴News item: <https://patimes.org/from-research-to-county-strategy-how-negative-learning-shaped-camden-countys-shared>

⁵News item: <https://theconversation.com/abortion-laws-show-that-public-policy-doesnt-always-line-up-with-public-opin>

⁶News item: <https://camden.rutgers.edu/news/rutgers-camdens-urban-innovation-fund-fuels-transformative-community-pro>